

William Blair

Work, research, publications, and awards.

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Work

- Episteme** 2025 — Present
Episteme Fellow · San Francisco
A privately funded Bell Labs-style research organization, around fifteen scientists working across neuroscience, advanced materials, energy, and compute. I design and build Atlas, the in-house researcher intelligence platform the lab uses to map talent, evidence, and direction across those pillars. I own it end to end: data model, ingest, LLM-driven extraction over open scientific corpora, and the product surface scientists use day to day.
- Aaru** 2024 — 2025
Founding Engineer · New York
Large-scale AI-agent simulation for consulting, politics, and government. Built the core platform with the CTO: the agent simulation runtime, synthetic audience generation, benchmarking and observability tooling, and the customer-facing web app. The synthetic-audience pipeline I shipped was used in every customer engagement.
- Biogenesis** 2023 — 2024
Co-Founder & COO · Palo Alto
End-to-end clinical trials platform, incubated as Engineer in Residence at Kleiner Perkins. Built the platform from scratch and hired a team of seven. Raised \$2.5M led by Jack Altman, with Kleiner Perkins and Fairchild. Stood up partnerships with small and mid-sized biotech across 250+ clinics.
- ThermoBeat** 2019 — 2023
Founder & CEO · Baltimore
Thermoelectrics for implantable medical devices. Developed a thermoelectric generator and boost-converter system that runs under a 2 °C gradient and produces 3.3 V, enough to power a pacemaker from body heat. Raised \$300K+ in non-dilutive funding across NSF I-Corps, NIBIB DEBUT, JHU Spark, and the JHU FUEL Grand Prize. Supervised by Dr. Andreas Andreou.

Independent

- Borrowed Light** 2025 — Present
Open infrastructure for scientific knowledge
Built independently of any employer. Encompasses Vela, a git-native protocol that turns scientific papers into structured, linked, correctable findings, with a working Rust reference implementation and an MCP server for agent reasoning over compiled state; the lead essay Constellations of Borrowed Light; and an open-source Obsidian theme carrying the same visual identity. Open spec, Apache-2.0 implementation.

Education

- Johns Hopkins University** 2019 — 2023
B.S. Honors, Cognitive Science; minor in Entrepreneurship · GPA 3.8
- Upper Canada College** 2015 — 2019
International Baccalaureate Diploma · Lang Scholar, one of ten across the school

Publications

- Emerging targets of α -synuclein spreading in α -synucleinopathies** 2025
Kuo G, Kumbhar R, Blair W, Dawson V, Dawson T, Mao X · Molecular Neurodegeneration
A review of mechanistic pathways and interventions.
- Optimizing a hyaluronic acid-based hydrogel for delivery of neural progenitor cells for ischemic stroke treatment** 2022
Blair W, Letko-Khait N, Shoichet M · Nature Technologies for Neuroengineering
- Evaluation of 5-aminolevulinic acid-induced fluorescence during breast cancer surgery with a handheld prototype imaging device** 2019
Gibson C, Ottolino-Perry K, et al., incl. Blair W · World Molecular Imaging Congress

Research

- Johns Hopkins University, Biomedical Engineering** 2022 — 2023
Advisors: Xiaobo Mao, Ph.D. and Ram Kumbhar, Ph.D.
Methods to inhibit PARP-1 activation in Parkinson's disease.
- University of Toronto, Chemical Engineering** 2022
Advisors: Molly Shoichet, Ph.D. and Nitzan Letko-Khait, Ph.D.
Hyaluronic acid hydrogels for delivery of neural progenitor cells in ischemic stroke.

Johns Hopkins University, Division of Neurosurgery Advisor: Youssef Salimpour, Ph.D. Novel neuromodulation techniques for epilepsy and Parkinson's.	2021 — 2022
University of Toronto, Medical Biophysics Advisor: Ralph DaCosta, Ph.D. Handheld fluorescence imaging device for breast cancer visualization.	2019
McMaster Children's Hospital, Infectious Disease Advisor: Jeffrey Pernica, M.D. FRCPC BALANCE-Kids: duration of antimicrobial therapy for bacteremia in pediatric patients.	2018

Fellowships & Awards

Z Fellows	2024
Kleiner Perkins Fellowship	2023
JHU FUEL Grand Prize \$25,000 · Founder, ThermoBeat	2023
NSERC USRA & PROMOTE Grant \$10,000 · PI, University of Toronto	2022
NSERC CREATE Fellowship	2022
Sigma Squared Fellowship	2022
NIBIB DEBUT Grant \$5,000 · PI, ThermoBeat	2021
NSF Regional I-Corps Grant \$5,000 · PI, ThermoBeat	2021
Hamilton Health Sciences Research Bursary \$10,000 · Infectious disease research	2018

Service & Teaching

Charm City Science League President · Baltimore Science Olympiad mentoring for Baltimore students, 100+ mentors across 20 schools. Managed a \$30K annual budget and led a 14-person executive board.	2022 — 2023
JHU Student Advisory Board President Biweekly meetings with university leadership on first-year orientation, housing, and student mental health.	2022 — 2023
JHU News-Letter, Sci-Tech Editor Led 20+ writers at roughly seven articles a week. Authored 25+ pieces on science and technology.	2021 — 2022
Johns Hopkins University, Krieger School Teaching Assistant, Leading Change (Entrepreneurship & Management)	2021 — 2023

Contact

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